# Jared Ren

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jaredren.github.io/portfolio

## Focus Areas

- Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW), Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC)
- AI-Mediated Communication, Human-AI Interaction, Future of Work

## Education

**University of Washington** — Seattle, WA, USA
M.S. in Human Centered Design & Engineering (HCI) — Sep 2025 - Jun 2027 (expected)
GPA: 4.00 / 4.00

**University of Toronto** — Toronto, Canada
Honours B.A. with High Distinction, Sociology and East Asian Studies — Sep 2019 - Jun 2024
Capstone: *Voice of the Customer* for Pune Municipal Corporation, India — Sep 2023 - Apr 2024

## Research Projects

**"ChatGPT, Review This Message to My Prof": Investigating Students' Use of AI for Online Communication in Academic Settings** — Jan 2026 - present
*Lead Researcher, University of Washington*
Designed and led an IRB-approved two-phase interview study (12 participants, digital-whiteboard elicitation, 110 recipient-channel groups consolidated into 31 contexts) on why and how students hand academic messages to AI; extending to n = 17 for a full manuscript. [p.2, n.2, m.1]

**Understanding Interns' Experience of AI-Use Uncertainty and Its Effects on Well-being** — Sep 2026 - present
*Lead Researcher, University of Washington (with Alex Foster and Colin LeFevre)*
Critical incident technique interview study of what interns weigh when deciding whether and how to use AI for work, the tactics they use when norms, permissions, or disclosure are uncertain, and the well-being effects they name; poster paper in preparation. [m.2]

**"I Can Talk to AI, but the Making Is Mine": Professional Artists' Use of Generative Agents for Creative Work** — Jan 2026 - Apr 2026
*Lead Researcher, University of Washington*
Led a 4-person team through an interview study with 5 professional artists on creative identity, authorship, and agency as generative AI enters their workflow; built a 68-code codebook in ATLAS.ti and framed the contribution distinguishing proactive, principle-based limits from reactive, quality-based fixes. [p.1]

## Publications

### Peer-reviewed posters and extended abstracts

[p.2] **Jared Ren** and Soobin Cho. 2026. "ChatGPT, Review This Message to My Prof" Investigating Students' Use of AI for Online Communication in Academic Settings. In *Companion Publication of the 2026 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (**CSCW** Companion '26), October 10–14, 2026, Salt Lake City, UT, USA.* ACM, New York, NY, USA, 4 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3785651.3831512

[p.1] **Jared Ren**, Manasvi Kale, Hsiang-Yi Lung, and So Eun Choi. 2026. "I Can Talk to AI, but the Making Is Mine" Professional Artists' Use of Generative Agents for Creative Work. In *14th International Conference on Human-Agent Interaction (**HAI** '26), November 16–19, 2026, Osaka, Japan.* ACM, New York, NY, USA. (to appear)

### Non-peer-reviewed publications

[n.2] **Jared Ren** and Soobin Cho. 2026. Delegating Before Learning: Where Generative AI Sits in Students' Professional Communication. arXiv:2608.28837 [cs.HC] (accepted at the 2026 **CSCW workshop** *'Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication'*)

[n.1] **Jared Ren**. 2026. An Account of Contribution Dissolution in a Research Team. Preprint to appear [cs.HC] (accepted at the 2026 **CSCW workshop** *'"Nobody Did This": Contribution, Originality, and Accountability in Agent-Mediated Collaboration'*)

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

[m.2] **Jared Ren**, Alex Foster, and Colin LeFevre. Understanding Interns' Experience of AI-Use Uncertainty and Its Effects on Well-being. Poster paper in preparation.

[m.1] **Jared Ren** and Soobin Cho. Full-length manuscript extending [p.2] (interview sample n = 17). In preparation.

## Work Experience

**Seattle City Light** — Seattle, WA, USA
*Continuous Improvement Intern, Customer Experience Division* — Jun 2026 - Sep 2026
*Publicly owned electric utility, City of Seattle*
- Owned the residential rebate process documentation and streamlining project: go-and-see interviews across four stakeholder teams, three validated iterations of swimlane and value stream maps, and an A3 with six countermeasures, each with an owner and a 30/60/90 plan; adopted as the baseline for ongoing improvements.
- Facilitated two cohorts of lean improvement training (8 staff each, 16 contact hours) for engineers, people leaders, and field workers, and coached each participant's improvement project; each cohort identified about $50,000 in annual savings.
- Coded survey responses from 29 staff across 16 divisions into eight themes with reach metrics and Likert statistics; authored the summary report for leadership.
- Planned and ran a full-day 5S improvement event at the Skagit hydroelectric project; handed the visual standard, audit checklist, and sustain plan to the on-site owner.

**Canada Revenue Agency, Government of Canada** — Canada
*Junior UX Researcher, Service Innovation and Strategy* — Jun 2024 - Aug 2025
*Strategy & Service Design Research Intern* — Jun 2023 - May 2024
- Conducted 50+ interviews, focus groups, surveys, and card sorts with small-business taxpayers on a 2-person research team; senior management built the recommendations into the next quarter's mandate.
- Co-designed, with a senior officer, a filing-responsibility decision tree used by 1,000+ business filers; validated the structure with tree testing, raising task success 66% and reducing frontline call volume.
- Sole owner of the division's SharePoint information architecture: research, restructure, launch, and weekly upkeep as primary page manager; intranet traffic rose 25%.
- Built, with a senior officer, a divisional KPI dashboard and process maps across business units; developed onboarding materials and organizational mapping; mentored the section's intern.

**HomeOptions** — Remote
*Operations Intern, 3-person operations team* — Jun 2021 - Dec 2022
*Real-estate technology startup*
- Designed a HubSpot CRM integration and built an automated lead-generation pipeline (Airtable population, form fill, contact emails); daily leads rose from about 20 to about 100.

## Honors and Awards

**Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award**, University of Washington — Fall 2026
**HCDE BS/MS Conference Fund Travel Award**, University of Washington — Fall 2026
**Honours B.A. with High Distinction**, University of Toronto — Jun 2024
**Munk Student Excellence Award**, University of Toronto — Mar 2024
**Kakehashi Project Award**, Japan-funded cultural exchange — Feb 2023
**Dean's List Scholar**, University of Toronto — Winter 2023
**Language Citation in Chinese**, University of Toronto — Winter 2021

## Volunteer and Community Service

**Seattle Asian American Film Festival (SAAFF):** Usher and Accessibility Volunteer — 2026
**Seattle City Light Family Day:** Registration and Check-in Volunteer — 2026
**Neighborhood Farmers Markets, Seattle:** Community Research Volunteer — 2026

## Skills and Languages

**Qualitative methods**: semi-structured interviews, focus groups, thematic analysis and codebook development, contextual inquiry, field observation (AEIOU), intercept interviews, participatory and community-based design, cultural probes, card sorting, tree testing, usability testing (moderated, cognitive walkthrough, heuristic evaluation)

**Quantitative and process methods**: survey design, Likert and SUS instruments, descriptive statistics, lean process mapping, value stream mapping, A3 problem solving, 5S

**Programming and tools**: Python (pandas, matplotlib, Plotly), LLM APIs (Anthropic, OpenAI), LLM fine-tuning, Git/GitHub, Jupyter, ATLAS.ti, draw.io, Excel, Jira, Confluence, SharePoint, Streamlit

**Languages**: English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (intermediate), Japanese (intermediate), French (conversational)